



HOLIDAY FUELING

Mini Guide





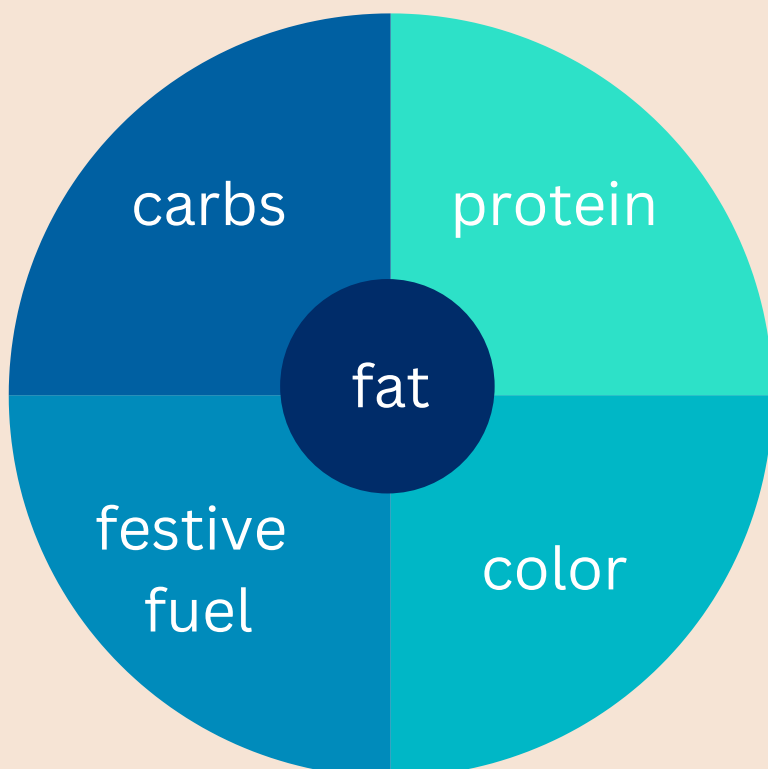
AVOID ENERGY CRASHES

The best way to avoid energy crashes? **Consistent fueling!** Eat something small before morning swim practice, and a full breakfast after. Breakfast is so important for maintaining energy levels throughout the day. And it doesn't have to be fancy. **For an on-the-go breakfast**, grab some microwaveable egg bites, an apple, milk, and a cliff bar (or other bar). **Consume 3 “main” meals and include carbohydrate + protein snacks around training.**



INCLUDE FESTIVE FUEL

Rather than restricting all holiday treats, include them as part of a well-balanced fueling plan! Know how your body responds to these foods, and use them to your advantage. A **gingerbread cookie** can provide quick carbs pre-practice, and a **mint chocolate smoothie bowl** (recipe at the end) with a candy cane can be a great **post-workout meal** to repair muscle and replenish glycogen stores.





GET CREATIVE WITH HYDRATION

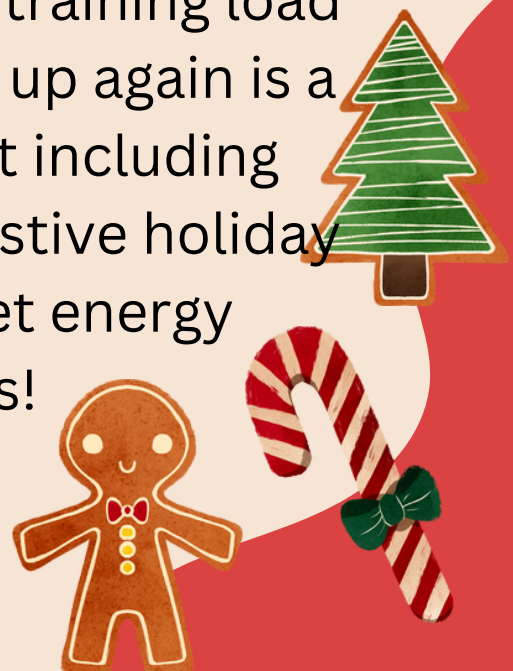
Hydration isn't just about water - that would be boring! Anything in liquid form counts toward your hydration goal. How about a mug of **hot cocoa** with ultra-filtered milk as a post-practice snack? A cup of **peppermint tea** (or other festive herbal tea) can aid in unwinding at night. **Cranberry or pomegranate juice mixed with OJ** or your favorite smoothie also help boost hydration and ensure you're performing at your highest level!



SHIFT YOUR MINDSET

Having a well-balanced fueling plan that includes both fast and slow carbs, fiber, anti-inflammatory fats, and complete proteins is essential. Rather than having an “all or nothing” mindset (all “healthy” all the time or “perfect” fueling), which can lead to restriction, under-fueling, lack of flexibility, and distress, it’s best to think of food options on a spectrum of **“Good - Better -Best.”**

After champs when training load starts to ramp back up again is a great time to start including small amounts of festive holiday fuel to help meet energy demands!



MINT CHOCOLATE SMOOTHIE BOWL

Ingredients:

- 1 banana (frozen)
- 1/2 cup frozen cauliflower
- 2 handfuls spinach
- 1 Tablespoon almond butter
- 1 Tablespoon cacao powder
- 1 greek yogurt cup (chocolate, vanilla, or unflavored)
- 1/4 teaspoon pure peppermint extract
- 1 Tablespoon maple syrup (if using plain yogurt)
- Optional: 1 scoop chocolate protein

Topping:

granola or your favorite cereal,
crushed candy cane, chocolate chips

Directions:

Blend all (except toppings) until smooth. Increase ingredients/add additions based on your goals and preferences!

